

**WOMEN OF THE ALT-RIGHT:
CONSTRAINTS, CAREER AMBITION, AND POLITICAL VOICE
ON U.S. FAR-RIGHT TALK-SHOW MEDIA**

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ABSTRACT. What role do women play in the U.S. alt-right? Existing accounts tend to portray women as marginal participants. We instead argue that while early-career alt-right women are constrained by traditional gender norms, they leverage these constraints for professional development, suggesting women are both legitimating objects and agents of change. We produce an original dataset of several thousand transcribed alt-right podcast episodes and use voice-based gender classification to compare the rhetoric expressed by women and men. We theorize two different pathways for women into power and prominence on the far right: a niche-to-platform pathway, in which early-career women gain entry by meeting demand for discourse on stereotypically feminine topics before broadening into the movement’s core issues over time, and a credential-entry pathway, in which women with pre-existing professional standing immediately address their core topics of interest but build less extensive far-right platforms as a result. Case studies and statistical analysis of gender-topic associations for three different far-right venues provide empirical grounding for these hypotheses. We find that women are more likely to discuss topics about children, education, parenting, and transphobic extremism, and, when controlling for time, also vaccination conspiracies, healthcare, and COVID-19. Although these themes play into traditionally feminine ideas about family and caregiving, they also constitute central mobilizing issues of the American far right. These results anchor the niche-to-platform hypothesis. We deepen our test of that hypothesis, and explore the credential-entry pathway, using case studies of the careers of select women featured on podcasts. Our findings reconceptualize women’s participation in extremist politics, showing how gendered expectations can simultaneously limit and enable political agency within misogynistic movements.

The leading actors, dominant voices, and most memorable images of the U.S. alt-right are predominantly male. From the Q-Anon Shaman (Conner 2023, Thompson 2023) to the Proud Boys (Kutner 2020, Campbell 2022) and the January 6th invasion

of the U.S. Capitol (Newton 2022), male leaders are proudly centered and men’s voices amplified. Yet the alt-right goes beyond simply being a movement created by and catered towards men: it is a movement founded on overt hostility towards women, corralling support through misogyny and anti-feminist rhetoric.

It is therefore noteworthy that despite the hyper-masculine and misogynistic dynamics of the alt-right, a wide array of women participate in and perpetuate the movement. Women take on prominent roles such as Laura Loomer, a political activist, conspiracy theorist, and recent Trump insider (Samuels 2025), or Chaya Raichik, a social media personality promoting far-right and anti-LGBTQ messaging (see LibsofTikTok as discussed by Cohen and Galloway 2025). Women also act as rank-and-file participants within the alt-right, contributing to the overall population of followers, donors, and protestors. While women have long permeated male-dominated and overtly masculine spaces as an act of defiance, seeking progress towards gender equality, women’s involvement in the alt-right offers a unique puzzle because this movement is designed to be malicious towards women. The alt-right is distinctive in that it is explicit about its misogyny, acknowledging sexism as a foundational aim of the movement and its role as an outspoken united front designed to combat gender equality (Darby 2020; Ging 2019; Kelly, DiBranco, and DeCook 2021; Leidig 2023; Shaw 2018).

This paper seeks to understand women’s role within the U.S. alt-right. Specifically, we ask how women represent themselves in male-dominated and controlled alt-right spaces by exploring women’s rhetoric on prominent alt-right podcasts hosted and run by men. Findings offer insight into how women navigate the overtly misogynistic space of the alt-right. Are women’s gendered bodies used as legitimating objects, referred to as a means of endorsing and validating sexist claims made by male members? Or are women agents of change, actively advancing the alt-right? Addressing this question offers insight beyond the U.S. alt-right, furthering our understanding

of gender norms within hyper-masculine and patriarchal spaces; tension between institutional norms and individual advocacy; and how anti-feminist and misogynistic rhetoric is perpetuated.

Our study analyzes several thousand far-right podcast episodes produced by Alex Jones’s InfoWars network (Van den Bulck and Hyzen 2020), comprising over 4,000 hours of audio recorded between 2008 and 2024. We compare messages expressed by women featured on these podcasts to those expressed by men. To do this, we produce text transcripts of podcasts by leveraging the medium-sized WhisperAI transcription model (Radford et al. 2023), and we identify topics discussed by individuals by applying BERTopic (Grootendorst 2022) to text corpora. We attribute specific speech acts to women or men through voice-based gender performance (Burkhardt et al. 2023). This enables us to identify, classify, and compare women’s and men’s spoken content across thousands of podcast episodes. By leveraging these data science approaches, this paper provides an expansive original dataset capturing the spoken words of a diverse sample of women involved in the U.S. alt-right, offering a comprehensive empirical approach to measuring women’s rhetoric within alt-right spaces.

We find that women are relatively more likely than men to discuss vaccination conspiracies, healthcare, and COVID-19, as well as children, education, parenting, and transphobic extremism — themes that play into traditionally feminine ideas about family and caregiving, but that are also among the most common and consequential conversations in the contemporary American far right (see Leidig 2023). Consequently, despite the alt-right’s misogynistic narrative, women are not necessarily disempowered within the movement: they leverage traditional gendered constraints to lead and promote some of its main themes. We explore women’s ambition as an explanation for this rhetoric through case studies comparing the careers of select women before and after their podcast appearances, combining the broad quantitative trends with a detailed analysis of the women involved and their motivations.

Existing literature on the alt-right centers male figures and the movement’s connection to masculinities (Kelly 2017; Shaw 2018; Sunderland 2023), or examines women’s *own*, self-hosted alt-right platforms (Blee 2003; Darby 2020; Leidig 2023). We instead capture a diverse sample of women navigating spaces that men host and control, offering an original theory of how women are simultaneously constrained by traditional gender norms and able to leverage that constraint for career advancement, achieving substantial professional and political success while also reinforcing anti-feminist ideological messages. In doing so, we connect literatures on polarization and the far right (McCoy et al. 2018; Mudde 2019) with literatures on gendered representation and power in politics (Childs and Krook 2006; Celis and Lovenduski 2018).

Literature Review: Women and the Alt-Right

We use the term “alt-right” as a blanket term for the disruptive counterculture right, distinguishing it both from the conservative right (i.e., the Republican Party) and from narrow white supremacist movements (e.g., the Ku Klux Klan and neo-Nazis). Terminology here is contested, and we recognize the alt-right as substantially the “latest iteration of a racist/white supremacist legacy, repackaged for millennial audiences” (Leidig 2023, 13), uniting “formerly distinct groups of white nationalists and the manosphere” (Sunderland 2023, 4). Despite disagreement among adherents on nearly every other issue, white identity and anxiety over immigration function as the movement’s foundational, unifying ideology (Hawley 2019).

We engage with “masculinity” as conceptualized by the alt-right specifically: a subset of masculinity grounded in traditional gender norms, anti-feminism, and out-right hostility toward women, echoing gender essentialisms common across far-right nationalist movements historically and cross-nationally, in which women are naturalized as mothers and caretakers and men as protectors and leaders (Heinemann

and Stern 2022). This coexists with a strand of benevolent sexism long central to white nationalist hate movements, in which violence has been justified as protecting “white women’s purity, honor, and goodness” (Darby 2020, 7), and in which traditional gender roles are treated as “vital to any grand political project” by figures such as George Lincoln Rockwell, founder of the American Nazi Party (Darby 2020, 62).

The alt-right is adamant that motherhood is “a woman’s fundamental duty” (Leidig 2023, 106), confining women’s proper role to the private sphere. Yet the movement goes further, blaming women for men’s perceived economic, political, and social “downfall,” a victim-based sentiment used to justify harassment campaigns undermining norms of consent (Shaw 2018) and even the claim that sex is a right owed to men.¹ Misogyny and anti-feminist sentiment are ubiquitous across the alt-right’s otherwise varied constituent groups, making women’s active participation in, and support of, the movement a puzzling phenomenon.

Historically, women in far-right movements have been cast as coerced victims (Girard 2024), but most alt-right women are educated, free from poverty, and did not “follow a man into the far-right movement” (Leidig 2023, 30). Blee (2003) identifies familial, social, and operative roles that women occupy in hate movements: birthing and raising children, recruiting and welcoming new members, and public-facing advocacy, respectively. This paper focuses on women’s operative roles on male-dominant podcasts. Where such roles between the 1920s and 1980s were largely limited to informal clerical work, contemporary alt-right women increasingly occupy influencer roles with a reach that dwarfs earlier recruitment through direct personal contact.²

¹An example of this argument is Giovanni Dannato’s 2014 essay, “Why Society Owes Men Sex,” written for the once-influential alt-right website *Return of Kings* (see Dickel and Evolvi 2023, Lamoureux 2018).

²The women influencers featured in Leidig’s 2023 book, “The Women of the Far Right,” range from having 149,000 followers (e.g., Lauren Chen) to 3400 followers (e.g., Ayla Stewart, i.e., Wife with a Purpose).

Existing analysis of these influencers shows how women weave alt-right talking points into seemingly benign commentary on parenting, self-help, and recipes (Leidig 2023). But this work examines women’s voices on their *own* platforms (see also Oak and Nielsen 2024; Squire 2019) — designed to appear to cater to women even when men comprise a significant share of followers, and centered on topics like fertility, dating, and motherhood. This context differs fundamentally from male-run and male-dominant alt-right spaces. While research has explored men’s rhetoric and behavior within these male-centric spaces (Hartzell 2020), much less is known about how women navigate them. This paper addresses that gap by asking how women navigate male-dominated and male-hosted alt-right spaces.

Theory: Women Leveraging Misogynistic Constraints

Women of the alt-right are often reduced in mainstream analysis to gendered bodies, i.e., objects used by the male majority to legitimate and mainstream sexist ideology — cited as evidence that the alt-right is gender-inclusive, or as an endorsement of policy centered on traditionally “feminine” issues such as child-rearing (Girard 2024; Leidig 2023). This view limits women’s role to a narrative controlled by men: women are validating objects because men use them as validating objects. Instead, we argue that while women may be reduced to gendered bodies in the eyes of male alt-right members, they are also effective agents of change.

Women’s capacity for influence has gained recognition within the alt-right (see Kisyova, Veilleux-Lepage, and Newby 2022; Leidig 2023; Llanera 2023; Mattheis 2018). However, less is known about *how* women influence male-dominated alt-right spaces. We argue that women leverage the alt-right’s misogyny, sexist talking points, and traditional gendered roles to accomplish three distinct, but related, tasks: 1) gain access to alt-right spaces and clarify their loyalty to the movement, 2) demonstrate

their value due to their unique ability to reinforce the core themes of the alt-right, and 3) harness their ambition to build their career and amass power.

First, overtly sexist rhetoric functions as a loyalty signal. As a visible minority amid outright hostility toward women, women who fail to voice anti-feminist and misogynistic talking points risk exclusion, or, in more extreme cases, being viewed as complicit in men’s perceived economic, political, and social decline. Women can go farther in the movement when “they didn’t hate men, and men didn’t hate them” (Darby 2020, 166) — a broader implication being that access to alt-right spaces is conditioned on vocalizing sexist talking points.

Second, women act as agents of influence rather than passive objects: sexist and anti-feminist claims resonate with a more mainstream audience when voiced by women themselves, on the logic that “it can’t be sexist if a woman says it” (Darby 2020). Rather than simply being pointed to by alt-right men as evidence of women’s support, women use their own agency to advance the same talking points, producing a more persuasive argument. By speaking sexist talking points from a sexualized body, women demonstrate value to the movement beyond the roles of caretaker or validating object, becoming uniquely positioned to advance its core anti-feminist aims.

Third, women act strategically on their own behalf. Leveraging misogynistic constraints within prominent male-hosted alt-right spaces builds brand recognition and popularity, which in turn opens doors to alliances with the movement’s overwhelmingly male leadership and, through them, access to power and influence within it.

Despite this, we recognize that women of the alt-right are undoubtedly constrained by the sexist foundations of the movement, channeled toward traditional gender roles and pushed toward femininity and deference: expected to be submissive to husbands, tied to the private sphere, and removed from overt political power. Women who occupy public space within the alt-right are heavily encouraged by the men around

them to at least open with talking points that align with these traditional gender norms. Successful women within the alt-right leverage these initial constraints by expanding their professional output to embrace other tentpole themes of the far right over time. We label these considerations the niche-to-platform hypothesis: women are heavily encouraged to limit themselves to feminized topics within the far-right ideological repertoire early in their public careers, but they can build a broader platform over time by appealing to the audience in these appearances and gradually introducing a wider range of core far-right issues. Our theory of this mechanism draws in part on research focused toward earlier iterations of the organized far right. Despite a formally gender-segregated Women’s Section within the interwar British Union of Fascists, women in that movement achieved public prominence and leadership at all levels. Women comprised 28 percent of stewards at BUF rallies, and one member recalled that, ‘believing as we did in the equality of the sexes, we took part in the same political activities as the men’ (Gottlieb 2004, 110). Individual careers could also move from gendered entry points toward less gendered public roles, as when Ann Cutmore joined the BUF’s paid staff as a secretary before becoming a regular contributor to, and drama critic for, BUF publications (Gottlieb 2004, 111–12).

Previous research has found parallel dynamics at work in far-right online media. Stern (2022) argues that feminized, care-giving topics projected through right-wing ideology (including homesteading, homeschooling, and family wellness) serve to organize women’s activism in building online followings and public standing. These women use superficially mundane conversations about domesticity to promote far-right ideology while evading the scrutiny directed at more recognizably extremist messaging (Stern 2022). While the online spaces Stern studies are important, it is noteworthy that they are largely self-curated and built by women themselves. Separate analysis is needed for the very large, often dominant online far-right media spaces produced and hosted by men. Do feminized entry points function similarly

when the platform is not one’s own, or does male curation create different gendered causal dynamics?

Applying this theory to women’s rhetoric on male-hosted and male-run alt-right podcasts, we anticipate that women will disproportionately discuss issues traditionally tied to women and femininity, such as caregiving. As their careers progress, we expect women to increasingly leverage these traditionally gendered topics to create a personal brand and the opportunity to speak on other issues.

A smaller set of women instead enter the alt-right from a position of established authority in other spheres. They are celebrities like Roseanne Barr, incumbent politicians like Marjorie Taylor Greene, or social-movement activists as in a case we will discuss below. We expect women who enter with established credentials to have the standing to avoid being channeled toward feminized topics if they so choose. Instead, they can immediately address the areas where their outside expertise gives them a platform. However, this may carry a cost, as well, since women with outside credentials may not spend the time cultivating a broad, supportive far-right audience that is a necessary part of the process for far-right women who do not have outside credentials. Hence, we offer the credential-entry hypothesis: women with previously established societal roles outside the far right will be less directed toward feminized topics, especially early in their time on far-right media, but they are also likely to build less varied and impactful far-right careers.

Our two hypotheses provide distinct explanations of, and predictions regarding, women’s involvement in the alt-right compared with prominent alternative frameworks. Tokenism theory suggests that women, as a small numerical minority in far-right media, should face heightened visibility and ‘role entrapment,’ remaining pigeonholed in narrow, stereotyped roles rather than broadening into core far-right issues over time (Kanter 1977). Tempered radicalism argues that women pursue cautious, identity-conscious influence through small, incremental acts calibrated to

avoid backlash, rather than the gradual platform expansion we hypothesize (Meyerson and Scully 1995). Resource mobilization theory uses access to organizational resources such as money, media infrastructure, elite allies, rather than gendered topic strategy to explain success within movements like the alt-right; this would predict that already-credentialed women should consistently out-perform newcomers, without distinction related to the rhetorical strategies of each (McCarthy and Zald 1977). Critical mass theory predicts that women’s behavior and issue scope shift discontinuously once women cross some threshold share of a movement, rather than changing across career cycles within individual women’s experience (Dahlerup 1988; Kanter 1977). Role congruity theory predicts that women who move into core, masculine-coded far-right issues face persistent backlash for violating gender-role expectations, implying durable containment within feminized topics rather than the possibility of successful broadening trajectories (Eagly and Karau 2002). Finally, the glass cliff literature predicts that women mostly achieve visible, leadership-adjacent roles during moments of organizational crisis or decline, implying that women’s prominence tracks the movement’s precarious moments rather than strategic choice within a gradually growing career trajectory (Ryan and Haslam 2005). Our niche-to-platform and credential-entry hypotheses depart from all of these accounts by treating topic choice itself, rather than numerical minority status, resource access, incremental tactics, threshold effects, or organizational crisis, as a major lever through which individual women’s far-right careers expand or stall.

Research Design

Podcasts have become a common source of entertainment and news for Americans, with 49% of the population saying they listened to a podcast in the past year and 27% using podcasts for news (Shearer et al. 2023). Accessible, affordable, and relatively unregulated compared to other media (Squire and Gais 2021), podcasts have become

a popular tool for recruitment, organization, and expanding the alt-right movement (Girard 2024; Squire and Gais 2021), and thus are the unit of analysis for our study.

This study focuses on women’s rhetoric on male-hosted alt-right podcasts. Previous studies have analyzed alt-right platforms directed and hosted by women (see Leidig 2023; Oak and Nielsen 2024; Squire 2019), but less is known about women’s rhetoric and role on male-dominated platforms: do women use similar rhetoric as guests on male-hosted platforms as on their own, and do they make the same contribution to the alt-right in both spaces? Analyzing podcasts hosted by someone other than the women themselves also captures a more varied sample. Social media influencer samples carry an inherent selection effect, since individuals must be willing to face public scrutiny to create and post original content; women on male-hosted podcasts, by contrast, range from one-time anonymous callers to influential, well-known guests, and some appear only involuntarily, through third-party clips the podcast uses to emphasize claims or incite listeners.

We analyze podcasts produced by Alex Jones’s InfoWars network because it is emblematic of the alt-right: InfoWars creates and shares anti-feminist rhetoric, pushes traditional gender roles, and has been critiqued for its misogyny and hostility toward women (see Hedge 2024; Norris 2023). InfoWars’ trajectory also mimics the broader alt-right movement, breaking from fringe origins into the mainstream as a source with real political influence: prior to being removed from Apple, Facebook, and YouTube in August 2018, InfoWars content was viewed nearly 1.4 million times a day, its YouTube channel had amassed 2.4 million subscribers, and its 36,000 videos posted between 2008 and 2018 had been viewed over 1.6 billion times (Nicas 2018). The network reflects the voice of its founder, but is also distinctive in the broad range of right-wing perspectives it has platformed (including members of the Proud Boys, Three Percenters, Oath Keepers, and Q-Anon) and in the close political and ideological ties it forged with the Trump movement in Congress (Holverscheid and

Seawright 2026) — making InfoWars a broad, inclusive, and consequential, though inevitably not fully representative, slice of American far-right politics.

Our quantitative analysis uses a random sample of 1000 episodes taken from Alex Jones’s InfoWars network. We begin by transcribing podcast audio using the medium-sized WhisperAI transcription model (Radford et al. 2023). Next, we divide each episode transcript by conversational turns, defined as uninterrupted speech segments by the same speaker. Speaker identity is determined using pyannote.audio (Plaquet and Bredin 2023, Bredin 2023). Then, for each speech segment, we identify the probability that the speaker was performing feminine gender.³ Given the importance of the gender estimates to this overall research project, we conducted a pretest, submitting a sample drawn from a pool of 40 coded voice segments to a collection of research assistants, asking them to code each segment as male- or female-presenting. We treated a modest pretest sample as adequate here because the underlying voice-based classification model had already undergone extensive validation by its developers on much larger benchmark corpora (Burkhardt et al. 2023); our pretest was accordingly a smaller, domain-specific check of whether that pre-validated model performed reliably on our particular data and speaker population, rather than an independent large-scale validation exercise. Agreement between the human coding and the software coding was perfect when a suitable measurement threshold was set, with one exception, in which Alex Jones performed a sing-song racialized caricature, which was coded by the software as highly likely to be female, but every human coder identified the clip as male-presenting. This example illustrates a broader limitation of voice-based classification: for some speakers, vocal performance can diverge

³We intentionally use the term “performing gender” as a means of reiterating our analysis of gender rather than biological sex. Recognizing gender as a performance (Butler 1990) allows us to capture nuance and range in gender identity, rather than being confined to a binary measure of gender, which does not accurately express the diversity of gender identities and the myriad of ways individuals choose to perform their gender.

from self-presented gender identity in ways a purely acoustic model cannot capture, and our gender estimates should accordingly be understood as measuring performed vocal gender rather than a speaker’s own gender identity. We additionally estimate the age of the speaker using a transformer-based model (Burkhardt et al. 2023). This transformer-based model is a second output of the same voice-based estimation pipeline used for gender: rather than relying on any speaker’s stated or documented age, it estimates each speaker’s relative age directly from the audio by evaluating a wide range of acoustic voice properties that are established predictors of speaker age.

The sample is heavily skewed toward male-presenting voices: approximately 95% of speech segments are coded by the software as more likely male than not.⁴ Given this extreme imbalance, even modest, symmetric measurement error could leave the female-coded segments predominantly miscoded male samples; to avoid this, we set the pretest threshold for classifying a segment as likely female at 1.0 on a log-likelihood scale (positive values indicating a greater likelihood of a female voice), trading some lost female voices for protection against this more harmful failure mode. We apply this threshold directly in the analysis below, coding each segment’s estimated gender as a binary classification (female-presenting versus male-presenting) at the 1.0 cutoff.

To determine what women are speaking about on podcasts relative to men, we identify the content of each speech segment using BERTopic (Grootendorst 2022), which leverages class-based term frequency–inverse document frequency (c-TF–IDF),

⁴Another demographic area of clear interest is the racial balance of speakers. While the composition of the alt-right in general is not entirely clear, the literature agrees that the movement is defined by a marked preference for whiteness (Taylor 2021: 15). Our data do not permit a test of racial identity, which cannot meaningfully be evaluated on the basis of voice alone at this time. Hence, we are unable to evaluate the reasonable expectation that the sample under study may be predominantly white.

topic representations, and dimensionality reduction to obtain salient keywords and an assignment of topic labels for every gender-estimated speech segment.

To validate the reliability of these automated topic assignments, we conducted a human-coding validation exercise in which three independent graduate raters each coded a random sample of 100 speech segments; individual raters agreed with the BERTopic-assigned label in 78–92% of excerpts, and a majority-vote human label agreed with the BERTopic assignment 86% of the time. Full validation methodology and results are reported in the online appendix.

To rule out an alternative explanation in which women engage in solidaristic feminist advocacy by describing female political candidates more favorably than men do, we conduct a lexicon-based sentiment analysis of each speech segment using the AFINN sentiment lexicon (Nielsen 2017); full methodology is reported in the online appendix.⁵

Findings

The most frequent topics in our sample are shown, over time, in Figure 1. The data include a mix of different kinds of themes. Some topics involve the management of the medium: station identification information (topic 0), product sales (topic 13), and conversational mechanics (topic 5). Some involve themes of standard conservative ideology, often given distinctive spins in the alt-right space but nonetheless readily recognizable: policing and gun rights (topic 2), Christianity (topic 3), and immigration politics (topic 11). Others are more conspiratorial: COVID denial and anti-vaccine politics (topic 1), anti-white racism (topic 6), banking conspiracies (topic 8), and foreign-policy conspiracies involving globalists (topics 15 and 17). Apart from

⁵This project was not human-subjects research requiring IRB review. Upon publication, we will make available the final-stage analytic dataset (segment-level topic, gender, age, and date measures) together with the complete code pipeline used to produce it, to support replication.

the surge of COVID and anti-vaccine conversation during the pandemic, the notable takeaway is that the mix of conversational topics is relatively stable over time, apart from the growth in volume of content produced during the Trump era.

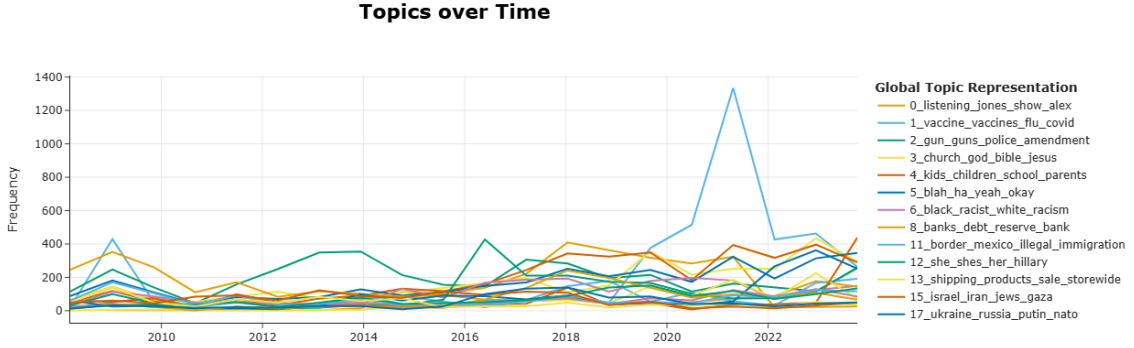


FIGURE 1. Most Prominent Topics Discussed in Right-Wing Podcasts Over Time

We focus on the set of most common topics listed in Figure 1, filtering our data down to speech segments within those topics. We then estimate a multinomial logit predicting the topic of each speech segment based on three variables: a binary classification of whether the speaker’s voice was coded as female-presenting (following the 1.0 log-likelihood threshold described above), the estimated age of the voice, and the date of the recording. We include estimated age and recording date as covariates to address the possibility that women have been differentially recruited into far-right media over time, such that the ideological moment of a speaker’s entry may leave lingering effects on her topic choices independent of gender. Immigration serves as both the model’s statistical reference category, selected as the modal topic in the corpus, and as the baseline topic in the comparison figures below: it is common in the data and, as established in our conceptualization of the alt-right above, immigration and white nationalism function as core, unifying ideological themes of the alt-right

even amid disagreement on nearly every other issue (Hawley 2019). To account for the substantial concentration of speech segments among a small number of speakers (the ten most frequent speakers account for 40.9% of segments in the filtered sample, with Alex Jones alone responsible for 30.0%), we compute cluster-robust standard errors via a nonparametric bootstrap (200 replications), resampling at the speaker level (`matched_speaker`) rather than the segment level. Our filtered analytic sample spans 8,432 unique speakers. Results are presented in Figure 2 below.

Results support the hypothesized gender asymmetry in topic distribution. Female-presenting voices are significantly more likely than male-presenting voices to appear in the two topics corresponding to the theorized feminine niche: Parenting, Schools, and Gender ($\hat{\beta} = 0.416$, $p < .05$) and COVID and Vaccines ($\hat{\beta} = 0.428$, $p < .05$, though comparatively sensitive to model specification, as discussed below). The two largest negative coefficients are Christianity ($\hat{\beta} = -0.843$, $p < .01$) and Show Management ($\hat{\beta} = -0.836$, $p < .01$), indicating that female-presenting voices are significantly under-represented in Jones’s evangelical-inflected religious content and in the production-focused meta-commentary that Jones and his male co-hosts dominate. None of the remaining topics (including Guns and Police, Female Political Candidates, and Race and Racism) reach conventional significance for the gender predictor, suggesting the asymmetry is concentrated in the predicted feminine topics rather than distributed across the full topic space — consistent with the niche-to-platform hypothesis.

We produced figures that show the predicted probability of several different topics in the multinomial model separately for male-presenting and female-presenting voices, holding age and recording date at their subsample means. Because the gender variable used in the model is binary rather than continuous (see above), these figures show a discrete contrast between the two voice categories rather than a probability

Multinomial logit model of speakers' topic frequencies
predicted by gender, age, and date

response	Gender	Performance	Estimated Age	Date
Christianity	-0.843**	0.157	0.007	
	(0.284)	(0.754)	(0.014)	
Conversational Filler	-0.182	-10.838***	-0.049***	
	(0.232)	(0.565)	(0.012)	
COVID and Vaccines	0.428*	1.914**	0.059***	
	(0.210)	(0.603)	(0.012)	
Female Political Candidates	0.131	-1.803*	-0.007	
	(0.242)	(0.756)	(0.013)	
Guns and Police	-0.420	-1.735**	-0.126***	
	(0.373)	(0.661)	(0.010)	
Israel	-0.185	0.631	0.046	
	(0.394)	(1.544)	(0.044)	
Parenting, Schools, and Gender	0.416*	-4.468***	0.010	
	(0.207)	(0.648)	(0.011)	
Product Sales	0.040	-0.324	0.026+	
	(0.232)	(0.664)	(0.014)	
Race and Racism	0.174	-1.921*	-0.002	
	(0.246)	(0.832)	(0.011)	
Russia and Ukraine	-0.183	4.345***	0.056***	
	(0.236)	(1.062)	(0.014)	
Show Management	-0.836**	-5.451***	-0.083***	
	(0.287)	(0.495)	(0.020)	
Num.Obs.	19947			
AIC	92389.4			

+ p < 0.1, * p < 0.05, ** p < 0.01, *** p < 0.001. Standard errors are speaker-level cluster bootstrap SEs (200 replications).

FIGURE 2. Multinomial logit model of speakers' topic frequencies predicted by gender, age, and date

curve across a continuous range. Predicted probabilities and their 95% confidence intervals are computed via the same speaker-level cluster bootstrap (200 replications) described above.

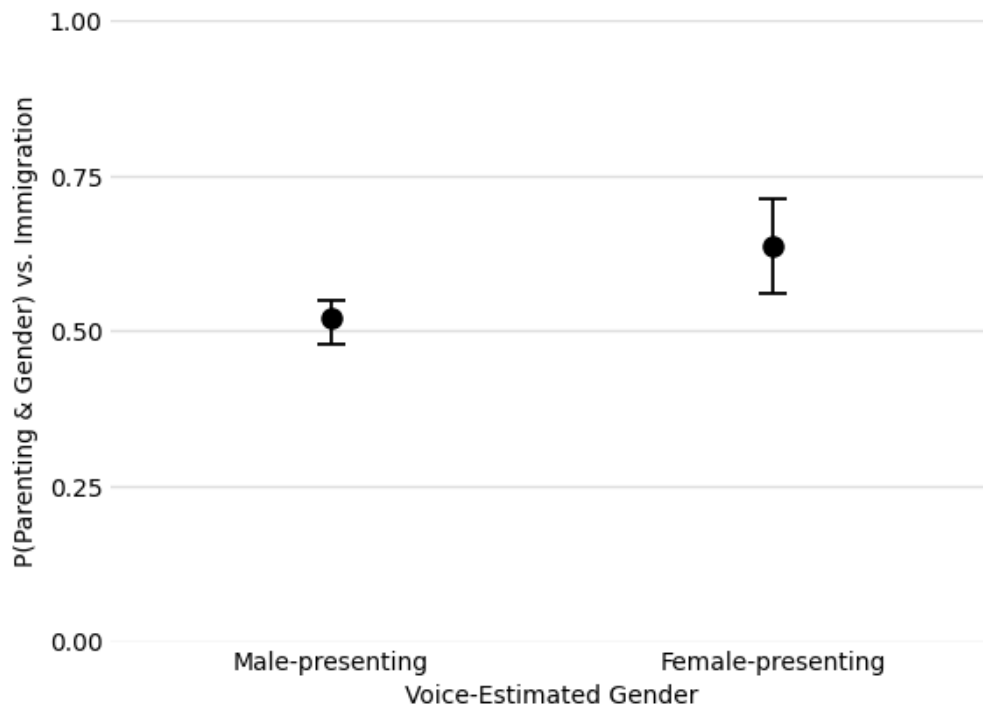


FIGURE 3. Predicted probability of Parenting, Schools, and Gender themes versus Immigration themes in the multinomial model, for male-presenting and female-presenting voices, with 95% cluster-bootstrapped confidence intervals.

Figure 3 shows the predicted probability of discussing the parenting, children, school, and gender topic relative to immigration, separately for male-presenting and female-presenting voices. The multinomial model suggests a positive and substantively large difference between the two groups: the predicted probability of raising the parenting-related topic rises from about 52% for male-presenting voices to about 64% for female-presenting voices, a difference of 11.6 percentage points (95% CI [4.5, 20.6]). Female-presenting voices are meaningfully more likely than male-presenting voices to talk about right-wing ideas connected to parenting.

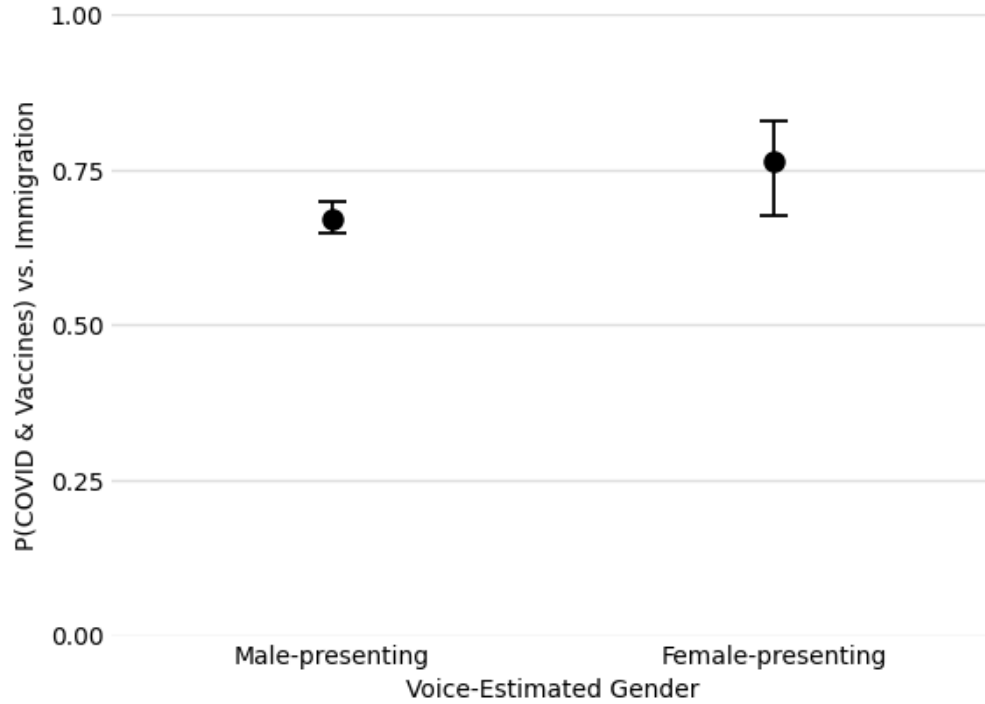


FIGURE 4. Predicted probability of COVID conspiracy and anti-vaccine themes versus Immigration themes in the multinomial model, for male-presenting and female-presenting voices, with 95% cluster-bootstrapped confidence intervals.

We find similar results for a comparison of COVID denial and vaccine conspiracy themes versus immigration themes, presented in Figure 4. Here again the multinomial model shows a positive, though more modest, difference between the two voice categories: the predicted probability of discussing right-wing COVID-related themes rises from about 67% for male-presenting voices to about 76% for female-presenting voices, a difference of 9.1 percentage points (95% CI [0.2, 16.8]). This effect is conditional on the date control included in the model: without temporal adjustment,

the COVID coefficient does not reach significance, consistent with the interpretation that COVID and vaccine skepticism crystallized as a distinctively feminine niche in far-right media during and after the pandemic. The COVID finding is also more sensitive than the Parenting, Schools, and Gender finding to the composition of the male comparison group (e.g., to excluding Alex Jones, who alone accounts for roughly 30% of segments); the online appendix reports this host-exclusion robustness check in full.

Notably, women’s aura of expertise does not extend to women in politics. Women and men speak about women political candidates at statistically indistinguishable rates relative to immigration (Fig. 5): the predicted probability rises only from about 37% for male-presenting voices to about 40% for female-presenting voices, a difference of 3.2 percentage points that is not distinguishable from zero (95% CI [-5.9, 17.0]). Moreover, a sentiment analysis (Fig. 6) shows that men and women in this sample use equally negative language when referring to women political candidates (often Hillary Clinton and Kamala Harris during the window of this study), indicating women are not endorsing or defending women political candidates. This suggests that alt-right women are not openly attempting to advance women’s descriptive representation within electoral politics as part of a broader goal to increase women’s political power. However, neither are alt-right women disproportionately critiquing other women to gain access to male-dominant spaces.

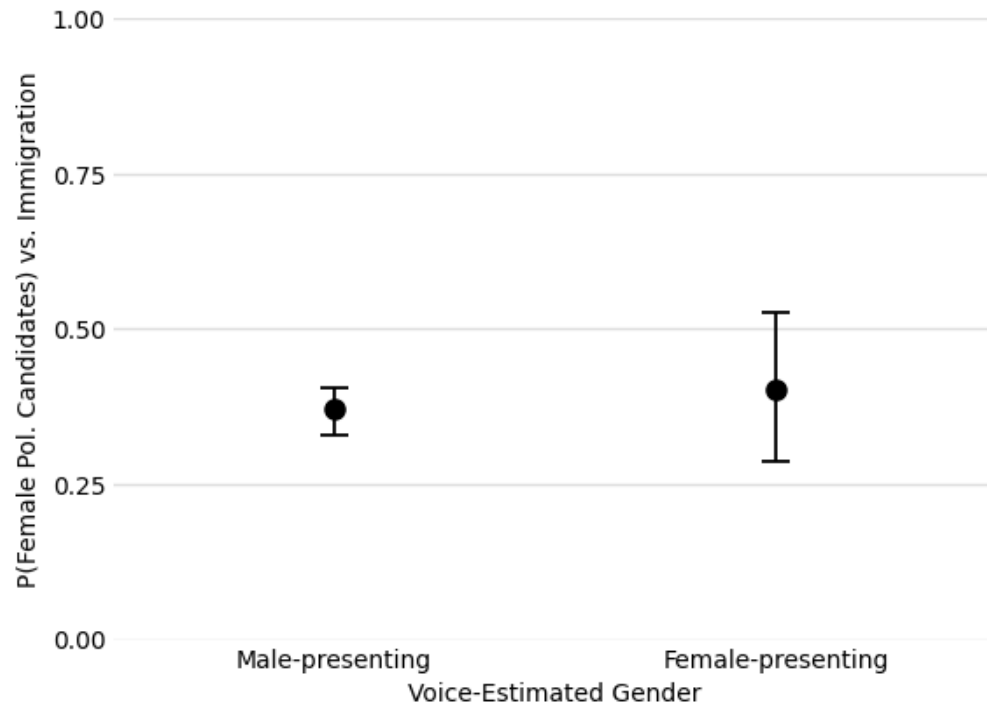


FIGURE 5. Predicted probability of themes related to Female Political Candidates versus Immigration themes in the multinomial model, for male-presenting and female-presenting voices, with 95% cluster-bootstrapped confidence intervals.

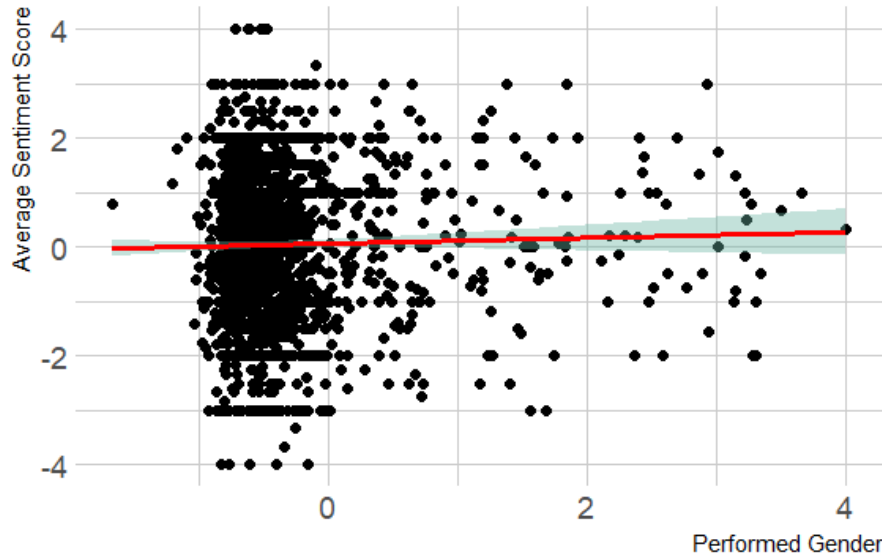


FIGURE 6. Average sentiment analysis score of speeches against estimated performed gender.

The lack of disproportionate critique might seem like a missed opportunity for alt-right women to curry favor with male leadership by signaling that they “aren’t like other girls.” But politics remains a male-dominated arena even among the general public (Bos et al. 2022), and men’s authority on politics is assumed in alt-right spaces, with even highly influential (and ironically overtly political) women claiming that “[they] don’t think women should be speaking on politics” (Ayla Stewart, featured in Leidig 2023, 101). Alt-right women may thus benefit from slandering women candidates, but risk deviating from traditional gender norms by becoming a dominant, outspoken voice on electoral politics; the fact that they instead keep pace with the frequency and sentiment of alt-right men, rather than disproportionately

targeting other women, is consistent with women being constrained by the alt-right’s gender norms even in this space.

Finally, gendered stereotypes regarding issues are contextual and may be subculture-dependent. Some readers may view religion, specifically topic 3 (Christianity), as stereotypically feminine, since women are known to be more religious than men in the U.S.⁶ But among far-right Christians, religious leadership and authority are almost uniformly male — Alex Jones, for example, routinely discusses having been called by God to serve as a Christian prophet during his teenage years, and his religious insights and prophecies are a running theme of his program. Accordingly, it is not especially surprising that women in our data are significantly less likely to speak about Christianity than men: relative to immigration, the predicted probability of discussing Christianity falls from about 57% for male-presenting voices to about 36% for female-presenting voices, a difference of -20.7 percentage points (95% CI $[-31.0, -8.2]$).

⁶Scholars debate the causes for the difference and the extent to which such differences are cross-culturally universal (Sullins 2006)

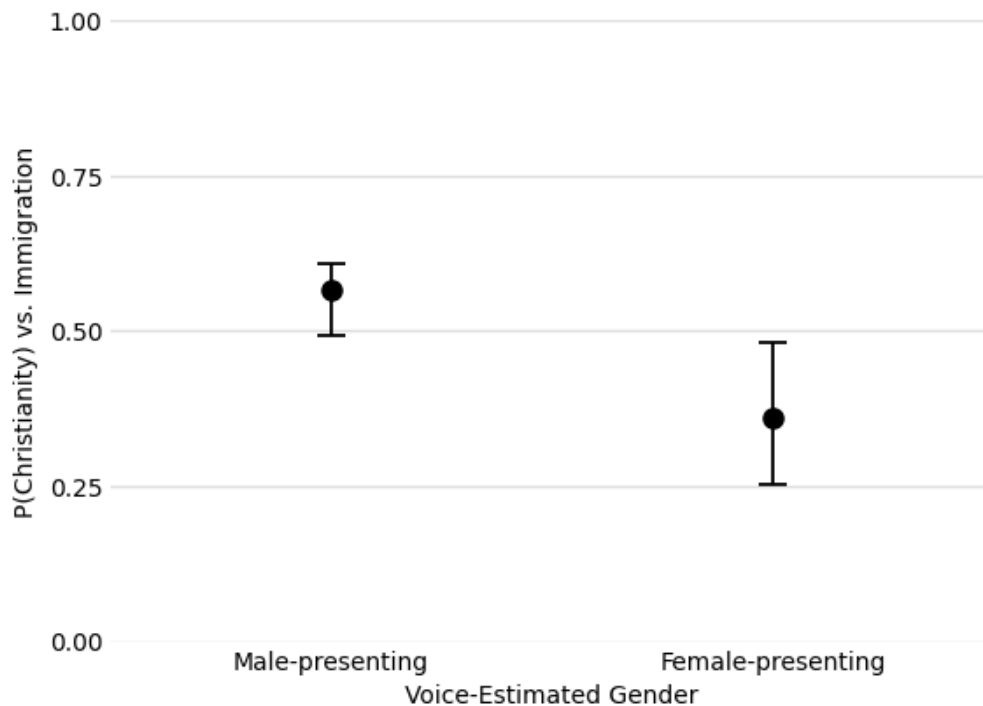


FIGURE 7. Predicted probability of themes related to Christianity versus Immigration themes in the multinomial model, for male-presenting and female-presenting voices, with 95% cluster-bootstrapped confidence intervals.

While these statistical results illustrate a pattern — women disproportionately speak to issues that are both associated with the alt-right’s traditional gender norms and among its powerful core themes — deeper questions about the realities behind these data require closer analysis via case studies, which highlight how selected women navigate the opportunities and constraints they face, and offer further insight into women’s ambition and their ability to leverage misogyny for personal gain.

As a deductive test of these findings, we apply a cluster-level permutation test to two additional corpora, assessing whether the gender-topic pattern identified in

the InfoWars multinomial model persists across structurally distinct far-right programs: the Proud Boys’ *Get Off My Lawn* (GOML) podcast, a male-dominated program built around aggressive masculine performance, and the Tucker Carlson Show, whose format books female guests primarily as credentialed political and media figures rather than as niche-entry participants building careers from a topic base — and for which the credential-entry hypothesis therefore predicts a weaker gender-topic association. Both comparison corpora require a cluster-level approach, since individual speaker identities are not linked to episode records; full methodology (speaker clustering, permutation procedure) is reported in the online appendix.

Results across all three corpora are presented in Table 1. Applying the permutation framework to InfoWars yields $r = 0.192$ ($p = .002$, one-sided). The Proud Boys corpus yields $r = 0.175$ ($p = .031$, one-sided; two-sided $p = .041$), replicating the InfoWars pattern. The Tucker Carlson Show yields $r = 0.108$ ($p = .077$, one-sided) — directionally consistent with the other two corpora but below conventional significance thresholds. The permutation null distribution for the Proud Boys result is reported in the online appendix.

The ordering across the three shows is suggestive of the theoretical account rather than a formal confirmation of it, since the point estimates should not be assumed reliably distinguishable from one another and the Tucker correlation does not itself reach conventional significance. With that caveat, the pattern fits our expectations: InfoWars is the most permissive niche-entry environment, featuring diverse female participants at very different career stages; Proud Boys GOML operates similarly but with stronger gatekeeping given its fraternal organizational context; and Tucker Carlson Show books women primarily as credentialed, established-career interlocutors, weakening — though not eliminating — the link between gender performance and topic assignment. Despite Tucker having the highest proportion of identifiable female speaker clusters among the three corpora, the correlation there is weakest

— a pattern consistent with, though not decisive proof of, the interpretation that credential-entry dampens but does not eliminate the niche-to-platform pattern.

TABLE 1. Cluster-level permutation test: weighted Pearson correlation between acoustic femininity and child/school/parenting topic share, by program.

Show	Topic cluster	r	p (one-sided)
InfoWars	Parenting, Schools, and Gender	0.192	.002
Proud Boys GOML	School + Children and Parenting	0.175	.031
Tucker Carlson Show	School + Children	0.108	.077

$n_{\text{perm}} = 10,000$; `set.seed(2024)`. InfoWars topic combines parenting, schooling, and gender themes in a single BERTopic cluster; other corpora split these across two topics, which are pooled here.

We also test whether this gender-topic relationship is stable over time, splitting the InfoWars sample at the November 2016 election and separately at the February 2020 onset of COVID-19; full results are reported in the online appendix. In brief, the relationship is strong before the 2016 election but attenuates sharply afterward as InfoWars’s production volume and speaker base expanded, a pattern consistent with an organizational-level echo of our niche-to-platform hypothesis, while the COVID-era split shows no comparable change, evidence against a simple secular decline in the gendering of far-right discourse.

Case Studies: Selection and Motivation

We use three case studies to explore aspects of gender performance and women’s political ambition on the far right that are difficult to capture in the quantitative analysis: choice of topics over time, how this dimension of gender performance facilitates career-building and platform construction, and the ways that preexisting fame

and relationships with show hosts condition topic choice. Cases were selected in two ways. The first two cases (Laura Loomer and Millie Weaver) were selected using the surprising causes strategy (Galvin and Seawright 2023) based on the quantitative analysis reported above, discarding three repeated instances of the same individuals to consider different dimensions of experience.⁷ The third case (Dr. Cynthia McKinney) was a deviant case (Seawright 2016), selected as the individual with the lowest proportion of stereotypically feminine topics among speakers with both a positive gender-performance score and a name that codes as female relative to Social-Security data.

Two of these women build platforms by working through the gendered demands of the space: Loomer’s appearances show a repeated pattern of cooperating with gendered expectations before pivoting to non-gendered far-right issues, and Weaver takes gendered performance further still, deploying stylized femininity as a strategic resource. McKinney, by contrast, is a former U.S. Representative and Green Party presidential candidate whose InfoWars trajectory bypasses gendered topic accommodation entirely, entering via institutional credentials — and, as the only African American among the three cases, raising the question of whether credential entry is the only viable pathway for women facing racial as well as gender exclusion from overwhelmingly white far-right spaces. Together, the three cases suggest the aggregate gender-topic pattern in the quantitative section may be a composite of distinct strategies, with a woman’s path of entry conditioning her subsequent advancement within the far right.

Laura Loomer: Gendered Constraints as a Pathway to Power

⁷Two repetitions of Laura Loomer and one of Millie Weaver were discarded; our sample nonetheless comprises hundreds of distinct women (a manual-coding lower bound of 200), so these two are unlikely to skew our quantitative findings. Full detail on case selection is reported in the online appendix.

Laura Loomer has a long, varied history with InfoWars, serving as an on-the-ground correspondent in the aftermath of the October 1, 2017, Las Vegas mass shooting and the February 14, 2018, Parkland high school shooting (Weill and La-Porta 2018). Her name has been mentioned on over 600 InfoWars programs, though appearances, third-party clips, and third-person mentions are difficult to disentangle; our data include seven confirmed on-air appearances between 2018 and 2024 (search methodology detailed in the online appendix; see Figure 8).

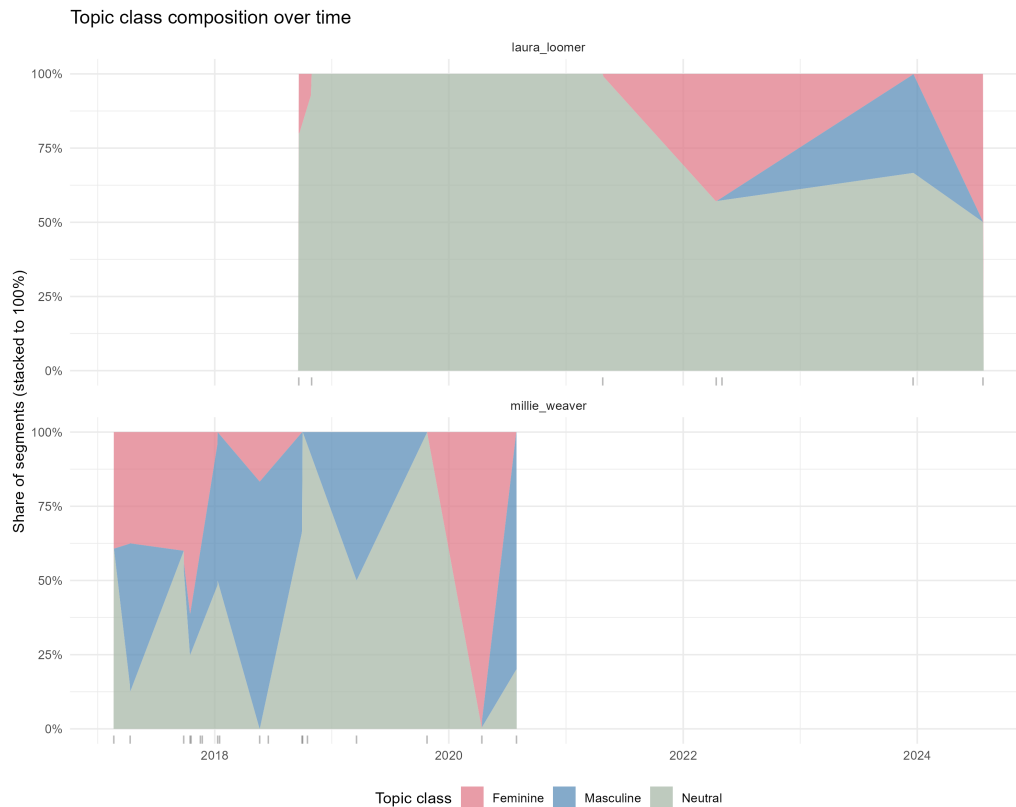


FIGURE 8. Appearances and stereotypical gender of predominant topics discussed by Laura Loomer and Millie Weaver on InfoWars, 2017-2024.

Loomer’s arc across seven appearances in our data (upper panel, Figure 8) traces the pattern the niche-to-platform hypothesis predicts, while also revealing a complication the basic account does not immediately anticipate. Her first three appearances predominantly feature gender-neutral topics; the next two introduce substantial emphasis on stereotypically feminine themes. By 2022, having won a Republican congressional primary in 2020 (losing the general election) and nearly unseated a sitting Republican incumbent in a 2022 primary, Loomer had established herself as one of the most visible far-right personalities in terms of name recognition and networks (Bensinger and Draper 2025). Her late-2023 appearance introduced a substantial array of stereotypically masculine themes, consistent with the hypothesis that a broadening platform loosens gendered constraints. Her final appearance complicates this picture, however: now an explicit Trump campaign surrogate, Loomer returned to heavily feminine-coded messaging, arguing extensively that trans people threaten children and that she, as a woman, had a particular obligation to speak against this. Platform growth had not dissolved the gendered constraints on her public role; it had reconstituted them around a new source of authority — from audience skepticism early in her career to the demands of a powerful political sponsor by 2024. The constraint was structural, not merely a startup phase.

The focal point for this case study is a November 6, 2022 appearance, shortly before the midterm elections.⁸ Having lost a 2022 primary and pivoted to producing political ads, Loomer used the interview to introduce and broadcast those advertisements at Jones’s invitation.

Introducing the segment, Loomer opens with “the groomer ad, the pedophile ad,” framing it as messaging on “the sexualization of our children” produced for a PAC supporting “pro-liberty candidates.” The groomer/pedophile framing invokes

⁸Transcript, audio, and video: https://fight.fudgie.org/search/show/aj/episode/20221106_Sun_Alex.

an ideological discourse common across conservative and far-right politics in which LGBTQ+ people are imagined as engaging in abusive efforts to convert young people (Peterka-Benton, Benton, and Penney 2025). Though the segment ranged across hyperinflation, Black Lives Matter protests as domestic terrorism, and COVID vaccines as elite conspiracy, Loomer and Jones returned three times to the messaging around LGBTQ people and children, making it the structural anchor for the whole segment.

Loomer here grounds a wide-ranging intervention in one of the topics our analysis identifies as distinctively feminine: the nexus of children, parenting, and LGBTQ threat narratives. This is strategic, not merely descriptive. At this stage she had sufficient credibility to range across inflation, domestic terrorism, and vaccine conspiracies, yet the children-and-LGBTQ frame served as the connective tissue holding the message together and marking her as a particular kind of speaker with a particular kind of authority — the gendered grounding is what makes the breadth legible to her audience.

After 2022, Loomer developed a close, very public political connection to Donald Trump — traveling on his plane and campaigning with him through 2024, and reportedly wielding pivotal influence over personnel decisions in the second Trump administration. Some interventions follow the gendered themes we identify as feminine-coded, as in her conflict with Surgeon General nominee Janette Nesheiwat over vaccine safety (Faulders, Walsh, and Pereira 2025); others, like her successful push to fire several National Security Council members (Haberman, Swan, and Bensinger 2025), had nothing to do with gendered topics at all, reflecting a now-established broader platform.

Loomer’s trajectory therefore illustrates two structurally distinct phases of gendered constraint. In the first, she leveraged stereotypically feminine right-wing topics — children, schools, LGBTQ threat — to establish credibility in a space skeptical of

women’s participation, broadening her range as that credibility accumulated. In the second, after achieving substantial visibility, she encountered a renewed version of the same constraint, now organized not around audience skepticism but around the demands of a political sponsor whose agenda required her to function as a gendered messenger. The niche-to-platform account captures the first phase well; Loomer’s later career suggests that the underlying logic does not simply dissolve once a woman achieves platform power. It reconstitutes itself around whoever controls access to the next level.

Millie Weaver: The Performance of Femininity

Millicent Faith Weaver, known professionally as Millie Weaver, had contributed to InfoWars since 2012 (Crawford and McGinnis 2020), serving as on-air correspondent under the name “Millennial Millie.”⁹ Her reporting ranged from factual, if emotionally heated, coverage of judicial conflicts of interest¹⁰ to climate-denial content.¹¹ In our data, Weaver appears in eighteen separate on-air appearances, apart from clips and reruns; see the bottom panel in Figure 8.

Weaver’s choice of topics over time illustrates the niche-to-platform hypothesis with unusual clarity: in her first year in our data, about half her appearances centered on stereotypically feminine topics, but as she developed an independent following — building social media under the Millennial Millie name from 2016 and reaching YouTube audiences of 100,000 or more by 2017 — the feminine-topic share of her InfoWars appearances fell substantially, for a period overwhelmingly favoring stereotypically masculine themes. The bottom panel of Figure 8 shows this arc plainly:

⁹Weaver’s current professional activities under the same moniker can be followed from her linktree: <https://linktr.ee/millieweaver>.

¹⁰May 13, 2013 InfoWars Nightly News: https://fight.fudgie.org/search/show/nn/episode/20130513_Mon_NightlyNews.

¹¹December 9, 2016 Alex Jones show: https://fight.fudgie.org/search/show/aj/episode/20161209_Fri_Alex.

early accommodation followed by a broadening that tracks her growing independent platform.

The focal point for this case study is her February 20, 2017 appearance, structurally unlike any other in our data.¹² Rather than a standard field report, this was a character-based comedy piece: Jones played the straight man while Weaver played a satirical Social Justice Warrior character introduced under the deliberately vulgar pseudonym Rainbow Snatch. Wearing a pink wig and carrying a hand-made anti-Trump protest sign, the character opened with “Shut up, you white male!” — immediately positioning femininity and its performance as the sketch’s organizing theme.

Weaver leaned into this framing immediately, her character announcing, “I identify as a multi-sexual, trans-dimensional, binary being,” and declaring in a cartoonish whining voice that “women don’t have any rights... men have all the good-paying jobs... we demand equal rights.” The satirical exaggeration works precisely because Weaver herself is visibly a counterexample to the position she performs: her presence on screen as a young professional constitutes, for the right-wing audience, evidence of gender meritocracy, lending irony to her words.

A critical moment comes when Jones raises a common far-right caricature of intersectional arguments for inclusion, asking, “Why are modern feminists so into Islamic stuff and, like, wearing hijabs?” Rather than breaking character, Weaver extends it: “...there are no Muslim terrorists. Okay, the only terrorists in this country are the white males.” Within a few exchanges, the character built as a vehicle for anti-feminist satire has delivered core alt-right messages about Islam, immigration, and the persecution of white men. Performed femininity served as the entry point; once the audience’s trust was engaged, the character became a delivery mechanism for a

¹²Transcript, audio, and video: https://fight.fudgie.org/search/show/aj/episode/20170220_Mon_Alex.

much wider ideological payload. Weaver is deploying gender performance in an even more sophisticated way than Loomer: where Loomer directly addressed feminine-coded topics to build platform credibility, Weaver deployed an explicitly performed feminine identity as rhetorical technology — a costume that licensed other messages by establishing her as a recognizable, trusted type.

This sketch dominated an entire three-hour broadcast, an extraordinary amount of platform exposure for an emerging personality. The character recurred across at least 29 subsequent episodes,¹³ with Weaver using the persona for street interviews at liberal events and on college campuses, where gender-themed openings broadened into partisanship, race, and Islam — replicating, episodically, the arc of her overall InfoWars career.

A structurally important moment occurs not during Weaver’s growing independence but its reversal. In 2020 she produced *Shadowgate*, a documentary claiming a network of military contractors had manipulated mainstream and social media, fabricated the Russian-interference investigation, and engineered police-violence protests (O’Rourke 2020), which generated open conflict with Jones (Crawford and McGinnis 2020) and her firing from InfoWars on August 19, 2020 (Azgard 2020). In one of her final appearances, while promoting the documentary and managing this deteriorating relationship, feminine themes resurge dramatically in her topic profile. The parallel to Loomer is instructive: where Loomer returned to gendered messaging when dependent on Trump’s sponsorship, Weaver appears to reach for the same tool when her standing with her primary male gatekeeper was under threat — gendered performance is not only a mechanism for building a platform, but also what women reach for when the institutional relationships sustaining it become precarious.

¹³Search: <https://fight.fudgie.org/search/keyword/?keywords=rainbow+snatch&exact=on&s=aj,an,hs,gmi,sr,sn,tnt,os>.

Weaver went on to build a successful independent career in alt-right media, earning income as a Twitch streamer (Weill and Rawnsley 2021) and a YouTube channel with roughly 67 million views as of August 2025.¹⁴ Her trajectory confirms what Loomer’s suggests: women in this space can build durable platforms through the strategic deployment of gendered identity, reinforcing the audience’s sexist expectations even while advancing their own careers. Where Loomer illustrates the topical dimension of this process, Weaver illustrates its performative dimension — gender on InfoWars is both a constraint on what women can discuss and a rhetorical resource they can inhabit and dramatize.

0.1. Cynthia McKinney: Credential Entry and the Limits of Platform Growth. Dr. Cynthia McKinney’s trajectory on the Alex Jones Show offers a third pattern distinct from Loomer and Weaver. Where Loomer gained access through topical accommodation and Weaver through performed feminine identity, McKinney bypasses both: her path runs through institutional credentials — a decade as a Democrat in the U.S. House serving on the Armed Services and International Relations committees, a post-congressional Green Party presidential candidacy, and a research and advocacy career centered on U.S. foreign policy and human rights. She is, in the vocabulary of the niche-to-platform hypothesis, a pre-credentialed entrant whose institutional biography already satisfies the need for the gendered accommodation that Loomer and Weaver each performed.

McKinney’s case is exceptional in a second dimension: she is the only African American among the three cases, and one of the very few people of color identifiable in the InfoWars corpus. The show’s speaker community is overwhelmingly white and male, reflecting its ideological center of gravity in white male grievance politics, its guest roster, and its audience. A woman seeking access to this space navigates

¹⁴See <https://socialblade.com/youtube/handle/millennialmillie>.

gender exclusion; a Black woman navigates racial exclusion simultaneously, so the credential-entry mechanism McKinney employs must clear both barriers at once — raising the theoretical stakes of her case: if credentials substitute for gendered niche accommodation, they appear also to substitute for racial accommodation in a space where people of color are structurally marginal. McKinney’s inclusion on InfoWars is framed not in terms of race or gender but primarily as an anti-war, anti-establishment former member of Congress whose positions on U.S. foreign policy, on 9/11, and on the illegitimacy of the two-party system overlap sufficiently with Jones’s own worldview to render her presence ideologically coherent — her institutional credentials collapsing both the gender and racial incongruity that her presence might otherwise foreground.

The credential-entry pathway is already visible in how Jones first positions McKinney: in a 2006 episode featuring Dr. Robert Bowman, a decorated Vietnam combat pilot and former Strategic Defense Initiative director, Bowman names McKinney as one of few sitting members of Congress willing to challenge official accounts of September 11 and the Iraq and Afghanistan wars, asking, “Is it only the Democratic women that have the cojones to do something?” Jones confirms her standing in turn: “And now they’re trying to arrest her” — alluding to her March 2006 altercation with a Capitol Hill police officer, which she framed as racial profiling and Jones reproduces as political persecution.¹⁵ McKinney functions here not as a guest to be introduced but as a known quantity: no topic accommodation is required because none is expected.

Her 2016 guest appearance confirms this pattern: Jones opens by citing her congressional career and subsequent international activism, noting that McKinney had

¹⁵The incident occurred on March 29, 2006, when McKinney, without her congressional lapel pin, was stopped at a security checkpoint and struck a Capitol Police officer who attempted to restrain her. A grand jury investigated but declined to indict her (Weiss 2006, A1).

reached out to come on the show — a notably different, top-down path relative to Loomer and Weaver’s bottom-up audience cultivation. The interview covers NATO, Hillary Clinton’s responsibility for civilian casualties in Libya, electoral manipulation and color-revolution theory, and intelligence-community management of popular culture — none of it touching topics our analysis identifies as stereotypically feminine: the theoretical signature of credential entry, platform access decoupled from gendered topic accommodation.

Two implications follow. First, credential entry is an alternative pathway, not a refutation: McKinney’s case shows the niche mechanism can be bypassed when a speaker arrives with credentials that substitute for the social function niche accommodation performs, establishing personal value directly, without gendered authorization. McKinney does not need to discuss parenting or vaccines because her congressional service, her public September 11 heterodoxy, and her opposition to U.S. foreign policy already mark her as a legitimate interlocutor; she enters as the female analog to Ron Paul, an institutional figure whose dissidence is legible through political biography rather than gendered performance. Notably, the same 2002 statements that established her standing with InfoWars listeners — her public suggestion that the Bush administration had advance knowledge of the September 11 attacks and stood to profit from the resulting wars (Eilperin 2002) — also cost her her congressional seat that year: she is legible to Jones’s audience not simply through her institutional record but through a record of heterodox dissent at institutional cost.

Second, and more consequential for the hypothesis, credential entry appears to foreclose rather than enable platform growth, and the racial dimension compounds this. Loomer and Weaver, both white women, developed ongoing relationships with the show through gendered strategies, accumulating episodes and eventually the audience visibility that enabled independent careers; McKinney’s footprint is sharply different, a single documented appearance preceded a decade earlier by a namecheck.

The credential that unlocks the door does not generate the recursive relationship between speaker, host, and audience that niche accommodation produces — consistent with the prediction that women who bypass the niche mechanism gain access but not traction. Whether that pathway was even available to McKinney is itself doubtful: if niche accommodation is what builds recurring relationships and audience familiarity, a Black woman discussing parenting or vaccine hesitancy in the InfoWars register would need to negotiate a racial legibility that Loomer and Weaver, both white, did not. The credential pathway may therefore be not merely McKinney’s preferred route but the only one available to her — the sole mechanism by which a Black woman can acquire ideological legitimacy that substitutes simultaneously for gendered accommodation and racial belonging. This may help explain a puzzling feature of her post-congressional career: despite a political profile — anti-war, anti-establishment, skeptical of both parties — that maps closely onto the InfoWars register, McKinney never became a recurring presence on the show, even as Loomer and Weaver, with far less institutional standing, accumulated far greater visibility within it. The niche mechanism McKinney did not need may be precisely the mechanism that builds the audience relationships Loomer and Weaver were able to monetize and extend.

Discussion: Gendered Constraints of the Alt-Right

Women’s rhetoric on alt-right podcasts subscribes to traditional gender norms. Topics on parenting, schools, and gender, and on COVID and vaccines, are profoundly laden with feminine connotations within the conservative U.S. cultural framework: women are imagined as caregivers, as educators and advocates for children vis-à-vis schools, and as intuitive nurses attuned to family healthcare needs, so it is “natural” that women are more likely to speak to these issues than men, and that men are less likely to. Men, too, are constrained by these norms — perceived as weak, for instance, by appearing to have expertise in child-rearing — so our finding that

women speak more to feminized issues may be driven as much by men’s reluctance to engage with women-coded topics as by any initiative from women themselves. Regardless, this finding supports the theory that individuals featured on alt-right male-hosted podcasts align with traditional gender norms.

However, women’s disproportionate engagement with anti-trans and anti-vaccine sentiment also suggests they are active contributors to the alt-right’s foundational issues and ideology, not merely passive conduits: ideas of libertarian freedom, hierarchy, and threat from shadowy conspiracies pervade topics related to children and “gendered threats,” just as elite conspiracies lurk behind hypothesized vaccine harm and globalist plots around COVID. When women discuss parenting, schools, and gender, or COVID and vaccines, they connect themselves to powerful ideological strands at the alt-right’s core — so women not only abide by the movement’s gendered constraints but use them to further it.

Women’s focus on traditionally feminine issues aligns with past research that finds women are primarily valued as mothers within the alt-right (Blee 2003; Darby 2020; Leidig 2023). Discussing divisive issues in terms of being “for the good of the children” gives women legitimacy on the matter while keeping them in their designated lane as mothers. Alt-right women influencers were, for instance, among the first to disparage the COVID-19 vaccine through conspiracy theories about its negative effects on fertility (Leidig 2023): as 2020 Republican Delaware Senate nominee Lauren Witzke put it in an October 7, 2021 interview on Alex Jones’s podcast, “remember the groups that want us to abort our babies [are] the ones saying, take this shot, we want to save you.” This tactic enables women to promote anti-vaccine sentiment (a pillar of the alt-right) while maintaining the guise of being a traditional wife and mother.¹⁶

¹⁶Similar child and family-focused reasoning is applied to condemning interracial marriage (“mixed-race children are more likely to have drug addiction and commit crimes”) and Black Lives Matter protests (“bringing children to protests uses them as props for the movement”), as well as justifying

Women’s use of motherhood and traditional gender stereotypes is particularly apparent when discussing transphobic extremism, ranging from the absurd claim that chemicals in clothing cause “gender-bending fetal development” (Leidig 2023, 124) to the insidious linking of women’s value to reproduction. Angela Stanton-King, on the July 20, 2021 Alex Jones Show, ties her views of transgender people inextricably to motherhood: “I am... the mother of an adult trans son...”¹⁷ the reason why this is so important to me it’s because I know if someone hadn’t made my son believe... he could be a woman, transitioning wouldn’t even be a question... Transgenderism is genital mutilation. It’s dismemberment, right?” Beyond couching anti-trans sentiment in commentary about motherhood, this condemnation of transgender individuals aligns with the alt-right’s view that women’s value is primarily based on biology.

Women of the alt-right equate womanhood with women’s reproductive systems. On the August 16, 2024 episode of The Tucker Carlson Show, Dr. Casey Means criticizes birth control medications for women: “these medications... literally shut[ting] down the hormones in the female body that create this cyclical, life-giving nature of women... there’s no repercussions for that, which... gets to a larger issue, which is a disrespect of life.” While this example directly opposes women’s reproductive autonomy, similar discourse elsewhere opposes trans women, misgenders trans men,

firearm ownership (“it’s our duty to protect our children from sexual assault”). (Quotes from Robyn Riley, “Rebel Revival #9: Life Updates and AMA,” August 16, 2020. Featured in Leidig 2023, 117; Robyn Riley, Instagram Story, accessed June 8, 2020. Featured in Leidig 2023, 118; Elora [Blonde Buttermaker], “Blonde Buttermaker: After Hours—Women’s Self Defense Corset Holster,” February 20, 2017. Featured in Leidid 2023, 121.)

¹⁷The terminology used here is challenging, both in terms of inclusion and intelligibility. Trans people typically prefer to be identified on the basis of the gender they present to the world. Thus, if Stanton-King’s child had transitioned from female to male, he would likely prefer to be described as an “adult son.” However, Stanton-King is using language in a trans-skeptical way, and identifying her child with the gender from which the child transitioned, rather than the gender she would prefer to present. The “adult trans son” Stanton-King describes is a person who transitioned from male to female, and calls herself a trans woman.

and disparages gender-neutral language — reducing womanhood to physical bodies and procreation, and aligning with the alt-right’s aim to emphatically link women with reproduction.

While our findings offer insight into the topics women disproportionately discuss, our data does not capture *how* women speak to all issues. It is feasible that women exclusively use feminine framing to discuss any topic: our topic model might code a statement as being about immigration when a woman is justifying ICE raids as protecting her children, or about gun ownership when she is arguing for self-protection from sexual violence. The gendered language women of the alt-right employ may therefore be even stronger than our statistical analysis suggests, making our findings a conservative measure of these gendered differences.

Overall, the women featured on alt-right podcasts simultaneously fulfill traditional gender roles by embracing feminine issues and leveraging motherhood, while also being active political agents. Topics related to children, education, health, and caregiving draw on feminine-coded roles to give women an aura of gendered authority within the heavily masculine spaces of the alt-right. This not only gives women access to alt-right spaces but also supports alt-right ideology and advances the movement. It also offers ambitious women an opportunity for personal gain.

Balancing Ambition and Constraints

Women of the alt-right build power and career longevity, paradoxically enough, by telling other women to avoid having a career (see a 2018 quote by Rebecca Hargraves in Leidig 2023, 202). As Candice Owens put it on the July 14, 2023 episode of her show, speaking to a male guest about his work as a conservative political YouTuber, “This is why men go to war, right? Why women stay at home. Not because of the patriarchy, because we are designed in this way. . . . You’re going to war while Corinne’s babying Beau and putting him into the crib.” Owens here operates from a frame of

gender determinism even though her own example complicates it: she occupies a similar career space to her male interlocutor. Women like Owens featured on alt-right podcasts have written books, produced podcasts, created YouTube channels, sold merchandise, and earned brand sponsorships to promote the alt-right's misogynistic talking points — the women who encourage others to surrender careers and financial autonomy for homemaking themselves earn hundreds of thousands of dollars a year.¹⁸ Ambitious alt-right women, however, seek more than monetary gains.

The women featured on popular, influential, and male-dominated alt-right podcasts leverage their exposure to amass political power. This is most clearly demonstrated through Laura Loomer's almost uniquely successful career, evolving from an InfoWars correspondent to a Trump insider who is credited with significant National Security personnel decisions (Herman et al. 2025). Loomer is by no means an outlier. Both Millie Weaver and Cynthia McKinney leverage their airtime to gain political power and influence. As these women rise in notoriety and demonstrate their unique ability to advance the alt-right's agenda, they may stray from traditional gendered talking points, weighing into traditionally masculine spaces like National Security (Loomer), foreign policy (McKinney), and electoral politics (Weaver). However, we see that even when addressing these gender-incongruent topics, women frequently frame their remarks in gendered terms, aligning with the constraints imposed by their alt-right base and reminding alt-right leadership of their unique position to influence.

It is narrow and unhelpful to view the women who choose to be featured on alt-right podcasts as passive victims, and it is a mistake to view them as producing benefits exclusively for the men who program them on alt-right platforms. At least some of these women have adopted strategies that give them a chance of benefiting significantly and creating real political power via the misogynistic platforms created

¹⁸This should not be interpreted as condemning homemakers or stay-at-home mothers, but rather highlighting the striking contrast between alt-right women's rhetoric and behavior.

and run by alt-right men. While alt-right men may attempt to reduce women to gendered bodies or objects by channeling them toward feminized topics, these women have the capacity to use their gendered positions to build a following and reap the monetary and political power that comes with it.

Conclusion

This paper explores women’s rhetoric on alt-right podcasts, asking whether women are used as legitimating objects, endorsing and validating sexist claims made by male members, or whether they are agents of change who actively contribute to the alt-right. We find empirical support for both: women are simultaneously constrained by traditional gender norms and able to leverage those constraints for personal gain.

We transcribe and analyze several thousand far-right podcast episodes, coding speech by voice-based gender performance to compare what women and men discuss. Women are relatively more likely than men to discuss vaccination conspiracies, healthcare, and COVID-19, as well as children, education, parenting, and transphobic extremism — themes that are simultaneously among the most common conversations in the contemporary U.S. alt-right and closely tied to traditionally feminine ideas about family and caregiving. Women featured on alt-right podcasts are therefore not simply disempowered by playing into feminine stereotypes; they leverage those stereotypes to lead and promote some of the movement’s main themes, countering the misconception that women are passive bodies who merely legitimize the movement through their presence. That said, men remain the ultimate decision-makers behind who and what is featured on these podcasts, and in a minority of cases clips of women are used without the featured woman’s permission (roughly 18% of a hand-coded sample; full measurement-uncertainty analysis in the online appendix).

We go on to explore ambition¹⁹ as an explanation for this rhetoric through case studies of select women’s careers before and after their podcast appearances, which highlight the variety of ways women are featured on alt-right podcasts and their agency within the movement even as they embrace a role in legitimating a space that seeks to confine them.

Women’s success within the alt-right happens, paradoxically, because these women maintain their femininity and stay within a pre-designed motherhood lane even as they demonstrate “traditionally masculine” agentic traits like assertiveness and leadership (Darby 2020). This study’s original dataset of several thousand far-right podcast episodes contributes to understanding women of the alt-right and their rhetoric in spaces run by, and for, men — showing how they navigate gender stereotypes both to advance their own careers and to reinforce the movement’s broader ideological messages.

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¹⁹This should not be interpreted as suggesting that women’s ambition is negative or unique to the alt-right.

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